

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	ENGL1006
Subject Title	Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Academic Excellence: Navigating University Writing, Research, and Communication with AI
Credit Value	3
Level	1
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	None
Objectives	This subject equips students at the Faculty of Humanities at The Hong Kong Polytechnic University with the essential skills to navigate the evolving landscape of English academic writing, research, and communication in the age of generative AI. Designed for an English-medium university, the course focuses on integrating AI tools responsibly to meet academic standards while fostering critical thinking about ethics, privacy, and cultural sensitivity in both local and global contexts. Students will learn how to harness AI technologies to draft essays, refine language, analyze data, conduct research, and collaborate effectively in multicultural academic settings. The course emphasizes the development of new forms of academic literacy, teaching students how to critically evaluate AI-generated content, ensure originality and integrity in their work, and adapt to changes in scholarly communication brought about by AI advancements. Through a combination of hands-on workshops, case studies, and reflective assignments, students will gain practical experience in using AI tools as partners in the writing and research process. They will also explore the challenges and opportunities AI presents, including its implications for creativity, authorship, and the future of academic discourse. By the end of the course, students will be equipped with the skills to excel in AI-augmented classrooms and future careers, prepared to communicate with clarity, professionalism, and adaptability in an increasingly AI-driven academic and professional world.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a. Demonstrate proficiency in AI tools for English writing (grammar, style, structure). b. Critically evaluate AI-generated content for accuracy and bias.

	c. Utilize AI to conduct research and synthesize multilingual/cultural sources; develop strategies to avoid plagiarism while leveraging AI assistance. d. Present ideas effectively using AI-enhanced visual and oral tools. e. Reflect on AI's societal impact and personal accountability in academic honesty.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	1. Introduction to AI in Academia: Overview of AI tools and university expectations; AI for English Writing: Grammar, style, and structure enhancement. 2. Research with AI: Sourcing, summarizing, and organizing information; Writing Workshop: Drafting essays with AI feedback loops. 3. Ethics & Academic Integrity: Plagiarism, citations, and AI transparency; Bias & Cultural Sensitivity: Addressing AI limitations in multicultural contexts; Case Studies: AI misuse scandals and lessons for ethical practice; Data Privacy & Security: Risks in AI platforms and safeguarding information. 4. AI-Assisted Collaboration: Group projects and peer review workflows; Intercultural Communication: Navigating language barriers with AI translators. 5. Presentations & Visuals: AI tools for slides, infographics, and speech practice; audio and video cloning and AI-generated content. 6. AI in Professional Contexts: Resumes, emails, and reports; Future of AI: Careers, lifelong learning, and societal implications.
Teaching/Learning Methodology <i>(Note 3)</i>	1. Lectures, with required readings assigned for each week 2. Whole class discussions, group activities 3. In-class presentations Weekly activities include AI tool simulations, peer discussions, and written reflections to reinforce English communication mastery in academic and professional settings.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes

(Note 4)

Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)				
		a	b	c	d	e
1. In-class active participation	15%	✓	✓			
2. Group presentation	30%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
3. Individual written assignment	55%	✓	✓	✓	✓	
Total	100 %					

Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:

Active Participation (15%)

Active participation through in-class discussions and activities accounts for 15% of the total assessment. It provides students with opportunities to demonstrate their understanding of AI tools for English writing and research practice, critically evaluate AI-generated content, and articulate their ideas effectively. These discussions and activities encourage students to reflect on AI's academic impact and personal accountability.

Group Presentation

The group presentation allows students to collaborate effectively and reflect on challenges encountered within a group setting. For this activity, students will select a real-world example of AI-generated writing and research practice issue, miscommunication or bias in the workplace, enhanced communication with AI, and related concerns that they find particularly relevant or thought-provoking. Each group will critically evaluate the chosen example by citing relevant course readings and additional academic sources, analyzing, for example, the benefits of integrating AI in academia or why the miscommunication or bias occurred, and proposing AI-supported strategies to prevent similar issues in the future.

Two-thirds of the presentation will focus on discussing the chosen example of AI-related issue. The remaining one-third will address the group's experience working together, including successes and challenges in using AI tools to assist with research, synthesizing multilingual/cultural sources, and presenting ideas effectively. This reflection will emphasize the group's strategies for maintaining academic honesty and avoiding plagiarism while leveraging AI assistance.

	Written Assignment The individual written assignment consists of a 3,000-word paper. Students will conduct an extensive literature review, synthesizing and evaluating information from a wide range of reputable academic sources. For this assignment, students must select a real-world example of an organization's success or failure in written or spoken communication involving AI tools or AI-generated content. They will critically analyze the reasons behind this instance, including potential biases, inaccuracies, or ethical considerations. Additionally, students will reflect on the broader academic and societal implications of AI in writing, research, and oral communication and propose strategies that could have improved the outcome. The chosen example must differ from the one used in the group presentation. Students should also connect their analysis to their own experience using AI tools during the semester, highlighting any challenges or successes in collaborating with peers or synthesizing multilingual/cultural sources. Only one-fifth of the paper should describe the chosen example; the majority should focus on critical evaluation, supported by academic literature.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures (13x 3 hours)	39 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Individual and group study	26 Hrs.
	▪ Written assignment	26 Hrs.
	▪ Private study	26 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	117 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Reading list to be updated. The American Institute of Mathematical Sciences (2025). Guidelines for the Use of AI Tools in Writing and Research. Retrieved from: https://www.aims sciences.org/index/GuidelinesforAI Adiguzel, T., Kaya, M. H., & Cansu, F. K. (2023). Revolutionizing education with AI: Exploring the transformative potential of ChatGPT. <i>Contemporary Educational Technology</i>, 15(3), ep429. https://doi.org/10.30935/cedtech/13152 Bretag, T. (Ed.). (2023). <i>Handbook of Academic Integrity</i> (2nd ed.). Springer.	

	Elsevier (2025). The use of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies in writing for Elsevier Policy for book and commissioned content authors. Retrieved from: https://www.elsevier.com/about/policies-and-standards/the-use-of-generative-ai-and-ai-assisted-technologies-in-writing-for-elsevier Farrelly, T., & Baker, N. (2023). Generative Artificial Intelligence: Implications and Considerations for Higher Education Practice. <i>Education Sciences</i>, 13(11), 1109. https://doi.org/10.3390/educsci13111109 Mohamed, K. & Albadawy, M. (2024). Using artificial intelligence in academic writing and research: An essential productivity tool. <i>Computer Methods and Programs in Biomedicine</i>, 5, 100145. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cmpbup.2024.100145 Southworth, J., Migliaccio, K., Glover, J., Glover, J., Reed, D., McCarty, C., Brendemuhl, J., & Thomas, A. (2023). Developing a model for AI Across the curriculum: Transforming the higher education landscape via innovation in AI literacy. <i>Computers and Education: Artificial Intelligence</i>, 4, 100127. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.caeai.2023.100127 Stokel-Walker, C. (2023). ChatGPT listed as author on research papers: Many scientists disapprove. <i>Nature</i>, 613(7945), 620–621. DOI: 10.1038/d41586-023-00107-z Thorp, H. H. (2023). ChatGPT is fun, but not an author. <i>Science</i>, 379(6630), 313. DOI: 10.1126/science.adg7879
--	--

Prepared by Eric Friginal, April 2025